

HABITATS



The earth is the only place in the universe known to support life. Like all other living things, animals occupy a zone between the lower part of the earth's atmosphere and the floors of its oceans. Although animal life is richest in the warm, wet conditions of the tropics, some animals have adapted to life in the hostile conditions found in arid deserts, high mountains, and the polar ice caps. Wherever they live, animals interact with each other, with other living things, and with their nonliving surroundings to produce complex, constantly changing environments known as habitats. This section looks at the habitats of the world and the animals that live in them.